



Heading to NYC?

Here's a list of nine popular apps that can help you get around and experience the best of an alien city http://dgit.in/NYC_Max

USB 3.1 motherboards incoming

Seems like everyone will soon jump on the USB 3.1 bandwagon as ASRock revealed two boards with USB 3.1 support at CeBIT http://dgit.in/AS_USB

Work@Tech

tion Board for Engineering and Technology (ABET).

Both, engineers and technicians can specialise in machine automation, medical robotics, cybernetics, quantum mechanical systems, air traffic management and a variety of other areas that utilise robots to make work processes easier for humans.

Robotics enthusiasts can also do fellowships available in research institutes, emphasising on humanoid robotics and computational neuroscience.

You earned a degree/diploma in Robotics, now what?

After attaining a degree/diploma in robotics, you can apply for internships offered at engineering and robotics companies. This internship can provide you with work experience and help you get hands-on experience in the field of your choice. You may consider applying with smaller companies that may not have a high industry profile.

Jyoti Sinha, CFO, Omnipresent Robot Technologies Pvt. Ltd., and faculty at IIIT Delhi states, "A Robotics Engineering degree holder is entitled to work in organisations, go to academic jobs, or open their own robotics startup. Along with a few big companies, some government organisations like DRDO are seeking good, technically sound robotics professionals, offering stable government jobs. To begin a startup, firms like Srijan Capital and Blue Sky Venture can provide you funding for your idea. Other than that, if you're interested in teaching robotics then one can do a Ph.D in robotics that's funded by government or private institutions like TCS and Microsoft research. Later, you can take up a job as a faculty in universities and educational institutes."



Jyoti Sinha, CFO, Omnipresent Robot Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

What are the challenges and advantages of being a Robotics Engineer?

A Robotics Engineer is definitely someone who finds joy in creating something new every day, solving unconventional problems, changing the common perception about robots and making an impact on our daily lives. "Being a mentor for primary and high school students, I see immense interest in these students for learning robotics, applying theories into the practical world and excitedly watching their creations actually

complete the programmed task", says Pankaj Saxena, a robotics engineer, retail IT consultant and Founder of Brampton Robotics, US.

The main challenge for a Robotics Engineer is keeping up with constantly evolving robotics technology and improving their capability each time. When looking for a job, you'll find yourself constantly dealing with companies seeking practical, creative and innovative engineers who can integrate technology into real-life applications.

Jayant Keswani from Milagrow states, "Anyone with great ideas can build a successful career in robotics, and even as hardware will continue to create opportunities, software opportunities will also proliferate and students will do well to focus upon them."



Pankaj Saxena, Founder, Brampton Robotics

How much do Robotics Engineers earn?

Robotics companies are offering decent salaries in India depending upon the experience of the candidate. At a nascent stage of the industry, due to the demand of robotics engineers, one can expect a fat

package. However, there's no standard package for robotics engineers. Your income will depend upon your qualifications, experience, organisation and the position you're being hired for. You could also apply at foreign companies, which usually offer better salary packages. "Given that most companies in the category are either startups and/or small organisations, the salaries are reasonably good, but if compared to some other established industries, they're a bit lower", said Keswani.

Since the industry is poised to grow at a fast pace, improved business performance will bridge the salary gap and ensure a significant growth in salaries over the coming years. Aakash Sinha from

Omnipresent opines, "Robotics engineers are likely to earn higher remuneration than their software counterparts due to shortage of skills in robotics." A fresher who wants to pursue a career in robotics engineering could earn a starting salary in the range of Rs.25,000 to Rs.40,000, while a professional with 4-5 years of experience can get Rs 1,00,000 per month.



Raju Vanapala, CEO, LearnSocial.com

Final thoughts

Robotics in India has many employment and entrepreneurship opportunities for students and professionals who wish to enter this field. This is a lucrative field for budding entrepreneurs looking to set up businesses, producing components and hardware for existing and upcoming domestic and international robotics companies.

If you're interested in building a career in robotics, you should start early. Students can enroll themselves in a high school internship or university co-op student program that will allow them to gain hands-on experience in the field. The only way to learn it is by building a machine and making it work! As the technology is constantly evolving, you must constantly update your knowledge and challenge yourself to look for fun solutions to unusual problems.